SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

November 04, 2026 | 04:24 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Mixed / Transitional

VIX 16.8 (-0.9 vs 20d) | SPY 20d -0.9% | IWM 20d +2.3% | IWM/SPY trend +3.3%

Leaders: Healthcare (+12.8%), Real Estate (+10.4%), Cons Staples (+10.2%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (5)	C - Early Stage (6)
ITGR	ANF	ASO
	SIG	BOX
	BRZE	VCTR
	ARQT	CWST
	HAE	INDB
		LNTH

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	**ITGR**	**Integer Holdings**	**MedTech Outsourcing**	**$4.31B**	**$126.64**	**$126.83**	**0.2%**	**+1.7**	**YES**	**YES**
B	ANF	Abercrombie & Fit	Consumer Discretiona	$7.26B	$171.09	$171.83	0.4%	+52.5	YES	YES
B	SIG	Signet Jewelers L	Consumer Discretiona	$4.92B	$128.40	$128.99	0.5%	+33.5	YES	YES
B	BRZE	Braze, Inc.	MarTech / AI-Driven	$5.24B	$46.10	$46.14	0.1%	+74.3	YES	YES
B	ARQT	Arcutis Biotherap	Dermatology Drug Com	$4.28B	$34.05	$34.80	2.2%	+35.2	YES	YES
B	HAE	Haemonetics Corpo	Blood Management Tec	$5.80B	$127.42	$128.82	1.1%	+45.6	YES	YES
C	ASO	Academy Sports an	Consumer Discretiona	$4.17B	$67.69	$67.76	0.1%	+41.6	YES	YES
C	BOX	Box, Inc.	Enterprise Cloud Inf	$6.04B	$44.05	$44.61	1.3%	+33.1	YES	YES
C	VCTR	Victory Capital H	Active Management Re	$7.39B	$120.19	$120.78	0.5%	+12.2	YES	YES
C	CWST	Casella Waste Sys	Defensive Infrastruc	$6.29B	$98.88	$100.03	1.2%	+11.2	YES	no
C	INDB	Independent Bank	Regional Bank Recove	$4.05B	$86.42	$87.24	0.9%	+4.6	YES	no
C	LNTH	Lantheus Holdings	Radiopharmaceuticals	$6.60B	$101.14	$101.27	0.1%	+0.8	YES	no

Not financial advice. Watchlist only - setups have NOT triggered. For informational purposes only. Do your own due diligence.

ITGR

Integer Holdings Corporation

$126.64

Pivot $126.83 | 0.2% away

RS vs SPY: +1.7%

A PRIME

$4.31B Cap | 29M Float

Medical Devices - Outsourced Components & Assemblies | Theme: MedTech Outsourcing & Cardiac Electrophysiology | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$126.83**
% to Pivot	**0.2%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.52 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**99.9%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**646k <**
Wk2	**939k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1038k**
Coil Strength	**37.8% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+1.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$4.31B**
Float	**29M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**42.5**
Fwd P/E	**18.4**
Rev Growth	**-3.9%**
Short %	**11.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$127.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $126.83 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (1.3M+ shares)

Target: $142.00 (12% measured move from 20-day base depth of ~$11)

Stop: $121.50 (base low, 4% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 29 - Q3 reported 6 days ago. Beat history: 4/4 quarters beat on EPS. Forward P/E 18.4x vs. peers at 22-25x suggests relative value. Street targets cluster at $127, implying limited near-term upside surprise unless guidance raised. Watch for analyst revisions post-print as potential catalyst.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Integer Holdings is a leading contract manufacturer of medical devices, specializing in advanced surgical, orthopedic, and cardiac/neuromodulation components including battery systems, leads, and delivery systems. The company serves all major OEM device makers (Medtronic, Abbott, Boston Scientific) with a sticky, design-in business model that creates high switching costs.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare sector leadership (+12.8% trailing 20d) provides macro tailwind. Secular theme of MedTech procedure recovery post-COVID plus aging demographics supports durable demand; peer Medtronic's recent quarter showed electrophysiology/CRM volumes accelerating, a direct read-through for ITGR's cardiac segment.

NEWS FLOW

No major contract announcements in last 30 days, but sector M&A activity elevated (Stryker acquiring smaller players) creates potential takeout narrative. Russell 2000 rebalance exposure neutral. Short interest at 11.4% (3.8 days to cover) is elevated but not extreme - potential fuel on breakout. Catalyst type: Industry (Med); impact: Medium.

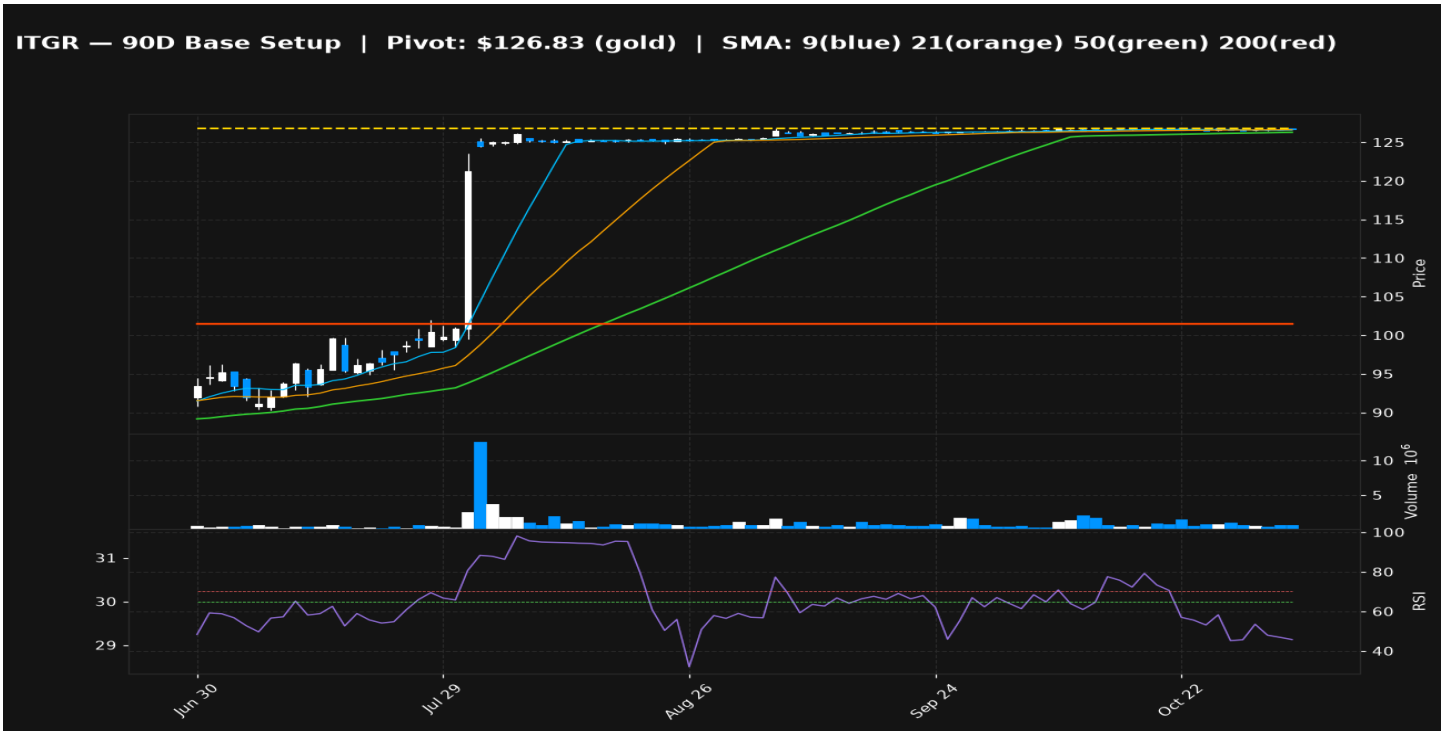
INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up is textbook institutional accumulation: 645K 938K 1038K strict weekly contraction with price holding at highs. No insider activity in last 60 days - neutral signal. Low beta (0.58) suggests defensive positioning; float at 28.9M is tight enough for meaningful price discovery on breakout. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $121.50 (base low / 50-day MA zone) or if Q3 guidance commentary revealed margin pressure from raw material costs not yet reflected in price. Customer concentration risk: top 3 OEMs represent ~60% of revenue.

Textbook VCP: vol_w1 < vol_w2 < vol_w3 confirmed, base_tight 1.52, RS line at 52W high, price within 0.2% of pivot. Healthcare sector leadership provides macro support. Just reported earnings with beat; post-earnings drift potential. Strongest bear case: limited institutional ownership visibility and modest RS vs SPY (+1.7%) despite sector tailwind suggests muted conviction from fast money. Conviction: High.



ANF

Abercrombie & Fitch Company

$171.09

Pivot $171.83 | 0.4% away

RS vs SPY: +52.5%

B BUILDING

$7.26B Cap | 39M Float

Apparel Retail - Specialty Teen/Young Adult | Theme: Consumer Discretionary Turnaround & Brand Revitalization | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | B

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$171.83**
% to Pivot	**0.4%**
Days in Base	**13**
Tightness	**5.08 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.6%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**876k <**
Wk2	**1140k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1333k**
Coil Strength	**34.3% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+52.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$7.26B**
Float	**39M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**14.8**
Fwd P/E	**13.3**
Rev Growth	**4.8%**
Short %	**14.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$165.82**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $171.83 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (2.2M+ shares)

Target: $195.00 (14% measured move based on prior base-to-breakout patterns)

Stop: $155.00 (9% risk, prior consolidation support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 24 - Q3 earnings in 20 days - high-impact catalyst. Street expects continued strength: 43.3% trailing earnings growth, forward P/E 13.3x is cheap for a 40% ROE business. Beat history strong. Holiday guidance will be critical; any inventory build or margin commentary will move shares materially.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Abercrombie & Fitch operates Abercrombie and Hollister retail brands targeting teens and young adults, having executed a multi-year turnaround under CEO Fran Horowitz focused on digital-first strategy, right-sized store fleet, and trend-responsive inventory management. The transformation has driven margin expansion and consistent comp growth.

FACTOR & THEME

Consumer Cyclical with strong RS (+52.5% vs SPY) but sector not in leadership (not in top 3). Theme of consumer resilience/discretionary recovery is mixed in current environment. Peer read-through: GPS (Gap) weakness suggests category selectivity matters; ANF's outperformance is company-specific alpha. Beta 0.98 means full market sensitivity.

NEWS FLOW

No major news in last 30 days. Short interest elevated at 14.9% (3.6 days to cover) - potential squeeze candidate if Q3 beats. No insider activity. Consumer sentiment data mixed but ANF has proven resilient to macro softness. Catalyst type: Earnings (High); impact: High.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction (875K 1139K 1332K) with price at highs indicates quiet accumulation despite elevated short interest. No insider buying in 60 days - absence notable given stock near ATH. Institutional ownership data unavailable. The 14.9% short creates asymmetric squeeze potential on positive earnings surprise.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $155.00 (prior consolidation low / -10% from current) or on Q3 comp miss / holiday guidance cut. Consumer discretionary names vulnerable in risk-off; base_tight 5.08 is loose by VCP standards - base still digesting recent run.

Strong RS at 52W high (+52.5% vs SPY), volume dry-up confirmed, but base_tight 5.08 is loose - needs another week of tightening for A consideration. Earnings catalyst in 20 days is well-positioned but sector not leading. Strongest bear case: consumer discretionary in mixed regime with high short interest suggests crowded positioning - if Q3 disappoints, the unwind could be violent. Conviction: Medium.



SIG

Signet Jewelers Limited

$128.40

Pivot $128.99 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +33.5%

B BUILDING

$4.92B Cap | 34M Float

Luxury Goods - Specialty Jewelry Retail | Theme: Consumer Discretionary Recovery & Engagement Spending | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$128.99**
% to Pivot	**0.5%**
Days in Base	**10**
Tightness	**5.97 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.5%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**737k <**
Wk2	**741k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**835k**
Coil Strength	**11.8% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+33.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$4.92B**
Float	**34M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**14.9**
Fwd P/E	**9.4**
Rev Growth	**-0.5%**
Short %	**18.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$124.33**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $128.99 on volume >180% of 20-day avg (1.5M+ shares)

Target: $148.00 (15% target based on short squeeze potential + earnings catalyst)

Stop: $118.00 (8% risk, base low)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 02 - Q3 earnings in 28 days. Street modeling modest revenue decline (-0.5% trailing) but significant EPS expansion (fwd EPS $13.65 vs TTM $8.62). Holiday quarter guidance will be the key swing factor. Beat/miss history not specified but valuation suggests low expectations baked in.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Signet is the world's largest retailer of diamond jewelry, operating Kay Jewelers, Zales, Jared, and Diamonds Direct banners across ~2,700 stores plus e-commerce. Engagement and bridal jewelry (~50% of sales) provides defensive characteristics within discretionary.

FACTOR & THEME

Consumer Cyclical sector not leading. Wedding/engagement spending has historically been recession-resistant but current environment shows mixed signals. RS +33.5% is strong but category is under-followed by growth funds. Forward P/E 9.4x is value territory.

NEWS FLOW

Short interest very elevated at 18.1% (5.7 days to cover) - high squeeze potential. Vol_ratio_today at 1.55 suggests unusual activity today despite being pre-breakout. No insider activity. Lab-grown diamond disruption remains ongoing thesis risk. Catalyst type: Earnings (High); impact: High.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction shallow (11.8%) compared to other setups; vol_w1 vol_w2 suggests incomplete dry-up. However, 18.1% short interest with strong RS creates asymmetric setup if fundamental catalyst materializes. No insider buying - neutral. Institutional data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $118.00 (10-day base low) or on holiday guidance disappointment. Lab-grown diamond pricing pressure and consumer discretionary softness are structural headwinds. Base only 10 days old - very early.

RS line at new high with strong relative strength (+33.5%), but base_tight 5.97 is loose, base only 10 days old, and vol contraction (11.8%) is weakest among candidates. Very high short interest (18.1%) creates squeeze setup but needs earnings catalyst to ignite. Strongest bear case: vol_ratio_today at 1.55 on a non-breakout day could signal distribution not accumulation. Conviction: Medium.



BRZE

Braze, Inc.

$46.10

Pivot $46.14 | 0.1% away

RS vs SPY: +74.3%

B BUILDING

$5.24B Cap | 94M Float

Software - Customer Engagement Platform | Theme: MarTech / AI-Driven Customer Engagement | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 26.43

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$46.14**
% to Pivot	**0.1%**
Days in Base	**12**
Tightness	**26.43 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.9%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**6434k <**
Wk2	**8074k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**9793k**
Coil Strength	**34.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+74.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.24B**
Float	**94M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**46.9**
Rev Growth	**26.2%**
Short %	**8.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$47.54**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $46.14 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (5.7M+ shares)

Target: $54.00 (17% target based on measured move from multi-month base)

Stop: $42.00 (9% risk, prior support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 08 - Q3 earnings in 34 days. Growth-stage company: trailing loss but forward EPS $0.98 implies path to profitability. Revenue growth 26.2% in tough software environment is notable. Street target $47.54 suggests limited near-term upside unless beat-and-raise. Watch for net retention rate and enterprise bookings commentary.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Braze provides a cloud-based customer engagement platform enabling brands to orchestrate personalized messaging across email, mobile push, SMS, and in-app channels using AI/ML. Serves enterprise clients including HBO, Burger King, and Etsy with high switching costs and net revenue retention above 120%.

FACTOR & THEME

Technology sector is LAGGING (-10.8% in 20d) - significant macro headwind despite company-specific strength. AI/ML theme in MarTech is less crowded than infrastructure plays. 26.2% revenue growth is standout in decelerating software environment. Valuation: P/E inapplicable (pre-profit); P/S 6.3x reasonable for growth profile.

NEWS FLOW

No major contract wins announced recently. Short interest modest at 8.3% (4.2 days). Technology sector weakness is primary headwind - BRZE has bucked the trend with +74% RS but swimming against the current. No insider activity. Catalyst type: Earnings (Med); impact: Medium-High.

INSTITUTIONAL

Exceptional volume dry-up (6.4M 8.0M 9.8M weekly, 34.3% contraction) with price at 52W high suggests textbook institutional accumulation despite sector weakness. No insider buying - notable absence given approaching profitability milestone. Float at 94M is liquid; this is an institutional-grade name.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $42.00 (prior consolidation zone / 10% risk) or on guidance cut / decelerating NRR at Q3 print. Technology sector lagging (-10.8%) means macro headwind could overwhelm company-specific strength. Base_tight at 26.43 is EXTREMELY loose - this is NOT a tight VCP base.

Exceptional RS (+74.3%) and volume dry-up pattern, but base_tight 26.43 is disqualifyingly loose - this is a wide, choppy consolidation, NOT a tight VCP coil. Technology sector lagging (-10.8%) is major headwind; BRZE is fighting the tape. Strongest bear case: loose base + sector headwind means breakout likely to fail or chop; need tech sector rotation to sustain gains. Conviction: Low-Medium.



ARQT

Arcutis Biotherapeutics, Inc.

$34.05

Pivot $34.80 | 2.2% away

RS vs SPY: +35.2%

B BUILDING

$4.28B Cap | 94M Float

Biotechnology - Dermatology Specialty | Theme: Dermatology Drug Commercialization | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 6.54

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$34.80**
% to Pivot	**2.2%**
Days in Base	**13**
Tightness	**6.54 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1866k <**
Wk2	**1882k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2716k**
Coil Strength	**31.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+35.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.28B**
Float	**94M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**154.8**
Fwd P/E	**25.4**
Rev Growth	**59.3%**
Short %	**17.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$39.12**

ENTRY TRIGGER

POST-EARNINGS ONLY: Close above $34.80 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (3.75M+ shares) AFTER positive reaction to Q3 print

Target: $42.00 (20% target based on analyst consensus + squeeze potential)
Stop: Set post-earnings - likely $30.00 area (12% risk) if reaction is positive

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 04 - EARNINGS TODAY (Day 0). This is a BINARY EVENT - setup requires post-earnings analysis. 59% revenue growth impressive; forward P/E 25.4x reasonable for growth profile. Watch for Zoryve Rx trends, gross-to-net dynamics, and 2027 guidance. High-impact catalyst occurring NOW.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Arcutis is a commercial-stage biotech focused on dermatological conditions, marketing Zoryve (roflumilast) for plaque psoriasis, seborrheic dermatitis, and atopic dermatitis. Transitioned from development to commercialization stage with 59% revenue growth driven by Zoryve uptake.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare sector leading (+12.8%) provides tailwind. Biotech cycle showing signs of recovery after 2022-2024 downturn. GLP-1 excitement has overshadowed dermatology names but ARQT operates in distinct niche. 91% gross margin is exceptional.

NEWS FLOW

Zoryve label expansion for atopic dermatitis approved earlier this year was major catalyst. Short interest elevated at 17.4% (6.1 days to cover) - squeeze potential on earnings beat. No insider activity in 60 days. Catalyst type: Earnings (High); impact: Very High (today).

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction (1.8M 1.9M 2.7M, 31% contraction) into earnings suggests smart money positioning. High short interest (17.4%) creates explosive potential on beat. No insider buying - notable absence ahead of major print. Institutional data unavailable.

KEY RISK

THESIS IS BINARY TODAY - invalidation is a miss or weak guidance at today's earnings print. If stock gaps down >10% post-earnings, setup is completely broken. Stop must be set post-earnings based on reaction. Biotech volatility (beta 1.63) amplifies both directions.

Healthcare sector leading, strong RS (+35%), volume contracting into earnings - but this is a BINARY EVENT TODAY. Cannot be A-grade when outcome unknown in hours. Base_tight 6.54 is loose. High short interest (17.4%) creates asymmetric payoff on beat. Strongest bear case: biotech earnings are notoriously binary; a miss could send shares down 20%+ given elevated short interest reversing. Conviction: Medium (contingent on earnings outcome).



HAE

Haemonetics Corporation

$127.42

Pivot $128.82 | 1.1% away

RS vs SPY: +45.6%

B BUILDING

$5.80B Cap | 45M Float

Medical Devices - Blood Management & Diagnostics | Theme: Blood Management Technology & Plasma Collection | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES |

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$128.82**
% to Pivot	**1.1%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.12 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.9%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**700k <**
Wk2	**603k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**938k**
Coil Strength	**25.4% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+45.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$5.80B**
Float	**45M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**61.6**
Fwd P/E	**22.1**
Rev Growth	**5.6%**
Short %	**8.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$124.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

POST-EARNINGS: Close above $128.82 on volume >180% of 20-day avg (1.3M+ shares)

Target: $145.00 (13% target based on measured move + sector multiple expansion)

Stop: $120.00 (6% risk, base low)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 05 - Q2 FY27 EARNINGS TOMORROW - high-impact catalyst in 1 day. Forward P/E 22.1x reasonable for MedTech. Revenue growth 5.6% is modest but stable; 2.9% earnings growth suggests margin pressure. Watch for plasma segment commentary and FY27 guidance reaffirmation. Beat history not specified.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Haemonetics provides blood management solutions including blood collection devices, plasma collection systems, and hemostasis analyzers. Benefits from rising plasma demand for immunoglobulin therapies and expanding blood donation infrastructure globally.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare sector leading (+12.8%) is direct tailwind. Plasma collection beneficiary as CSL, Takeda expand capacity for Ig therapies. Medical device recovery theme aligned with hospital procedure volumes normalizing. Low beta (0.59) = defensive positioning.

NEWS FLOW

No major contract announcements. Short interest manageable at 8.8% (4.8 days). Sector M&A activity could make HAE a target given specialized niche. No insider activity. Earnings tomorrow is THE catalyst. Catalyst type: Earnings (High); impact: High.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume pattern mixed: vol_w1 < vol_w2 BUT vol_w2 > vol_w3 (700K 603K 938K) - not strict stair-step contraction. This is imperfect VCP structure. No insider buying. Institutional data unavailable. Base_tight 3.12 is acceptable but not elite.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $120.00 (base low / 6% risk) or on earnings miss/guidance cut TOMORROW. Debt/equity 140% is elevated for MedTech. Single-day event risk is high - untradeable until post-earnings.

Healthcare sector leading with strong RS (+45.6%), but vol_dryup_strict is FALSE - volume pattern is imperfect (w2 < w1 < w3). Earnings TOMORROW makes this binary. Base_tight 3.12 is decent but not A-grade tight. Strongest bear case: debt/equity 140% and modest growth profile (5.6% rev / 2.9% EPS) suggest valuation is full - limited upside surprise potential. Conviction: Medium.



ASO

Academy Sports and Outdoors, Inc.

$67.69

Pivot $67.76 | 0.1% away

RS vs SPY: +41.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.17B Cap | 61M Float

Specialty Retail - Sporting Goods | Theme: Consumer Discretionary & Active Lifestyle | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.17

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$67.76**
% to Pivot	**0.1%**
Days in Base	**3**
Tightness	**7.17 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.9%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1377k <**
Wk2	**1175k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1441k**
Coil Strength	**4.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+41.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.17B**
Float	**61M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**11.4**
Fwd P/E	**9.6**
Rev Growth	**3.0%**
Short %	**23.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$60.89**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $67.76 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (2.55M+ shares)

Target: $78.00 (15% target, short squeeze premium)

Stop: $62.00 (8% risk, prior resistance-turned-support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 08 - Q3 earnings in 34 days. Forward P/E 9.6x and PEG 0.62 indicate significant value vs growth profile (17.3% earnings growth). Street target $60.89 is BELOW current price - contrarian setup. Holiday guidance will be critical.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Academy Sports operates 285+ sporting goods stores across the South and Southeast US, offering a broad assortment of outdoor, sports, and lifestyle merchandise. Value-oriented positioning with strong regional brand loyalty and efficient supply chain.

FACTOR & THEME

Consumer Cyclical sector not leading but ASO has strong company-specific RS (+41.6%). Sporting goods retail faced post-COVID normalization headwinds but ASO has outperformed peers (DKS, HIBB). Very low PEG (0.62) suggests value opportunity.

NEWS FLOW

Very high short interest at 23.4% (5.7 days to cover) - HIGHEST among candidates. This is a potential squeeze candidate but also reflects real bear thesis (outdoor/sporting goods normalization). Vol_ratio_today 1.82 suggests unusual activity. No insider buying. Catalyst type: Earnings (High); impact: High.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction weak (4.4%) and pattern imperfect (w2 < w1, w3 w1). Vol_dryup_strict is FALSE. Base only 3 days old - too early. 23.4% short interest is a double-edged sword: squeeze fuel OR smart money shorting for a reason. No insider buying.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $62.00 (prior pivot / 8% risk) or on Q3 comp miss / inventory build commentary. 23.4% short interest suggests strong bear thesis exists - outdoor/sporting goods sector has normalized post-COVID.

Extremely high short interest (23.4%) creates squeeze potential, but base only 3 days old, base_tight 7.17 is loose, vol contraction only 4.4% (weakest among candidates), and vol_dryup_strict is FALSE. Too early - needs 1-2 more weeks of tightening. Street target below current price is bearish signal. Conviction: Low.



BOX

Box, Inc.

$44.05

Pivot $44.61 | 1.3% away

RS vs SPY: +33.1%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.04B Cap | 132M Float

Software - Cloud Content Management | Theme: Enterprise Cloud Infrastructure & AI Integration | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.2

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$44.61**
% to Pivot	**1.3%**
Days in Base	**13**
Tightness	**7.20 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.7%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**2654k <**
Wk2	**2860k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2721k**
Coil Strength	**2.5% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+33.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$6.04B**
Float	**132M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**63.8**
Fwd P/E	**25.3**
Rev Growth	**9.2%**
Short %	**15.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$39.86**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $44.61 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (3.6M+ shares)

Target: $50.00 (12% measured move)

Stop: $40.50 (8% risk, 50-day MA zone)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 01

Technology sector lagging (-10.8%), base_tight 7.2 is loose, vol contraction minimal (2.5%). RS line at high but swimming against sector headwind. Debt/equity 379% is concerning. Needs sector rotation and base tightening before consideration. Conviction: Low.



VCTR

Victory Capital Holdings, Inc.

$120.19

Pivot $120.78 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +12.2%

C EARLY STAGE

$7.39B Cap | 46M Float

Asset Management | Theme: Active Management Recovery & AUM Growth | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.95

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$120.78**
% to Pivot	**0.5%**
Days in Base	**15**
Tightness	**3.95 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.3%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**565k <**
Wk2	**386k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**595k**
Coil Strength	**5.1% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+12.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$7.39B**
Float	**46M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**22.0**
Fwd P/E	**14.0**
Rev Growth	**24.0%**
Short %	**7.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$123.67**

ENTRY TRIGGER

POST-EARNINGS: Close above $120.78 on volume >180% of 20-day avg (1.15M+ shares)

Target: $135.00 (12% target)

Stop: $112.00 (7% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 04

Earnings TODAY makes this binary - cannot evaluate until post-print. Vol_dryup_strict FALSE with imperfect weekly pattern. RS only +12.2% is modest. Financial Services sector neutral. Wait for earnings reaction before considering. Conviction: Low.



CWST

Casella Waste Systems, Inc.

$98.88

Pivot $100.03 | 1.2% away

RS vs SPY: +11.2%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.29B Cap | 62M Float

Waste Management | Theme: Defensive Infrastructure & Recurring Revenue | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.26

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$100.03**
% to Pivot	**1.2%**
Days in Base	**11**
Tightness	**5.26 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**91.6%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**591k <**
Wk2	**724k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**733k**
Coil Strength	**19.4% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+11.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$6.29B**
Float	**62M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**1098.7**
Fwd P/E	**69.4**
Rev Growth	**16.9%**
Short %	**10.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$106.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $100.03 on volume >160% of 20-day avg (930K+ shares)

Target: $110.00 (10% target)

Stop: $94.00 (5% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 09

RS line NOT at new high (only 91.6% of 52W high), earnings in 5 days is near-term binary risk. Trailing P/E 1098x reflects one-time items but masks weak profitability. Earnings growth -25.9% is concerning. Needs earnings beat to re-rate. Conviction: Low.



INDB

Independent Bank Corp.

$86.42

Pivot $87.24 | 0.9% away

RS vs SPY: +4.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.05B Cap | 46M Float

Banks - Regional | Theme: Regional Bank Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 6.3

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$87.24**
% to Pivot	**0.9%**
Days in Base	**14**
Tightness	**6.30 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**343k <**
Wk2	**426k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**589k**
Coil Strength	**41.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+4.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.05B**
Float	**46M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.7**
Fwd P/E	**10.4**
Rev Growth	**24.5%**
Short %	**6.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$94.57**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $87.24 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (555K+ shares)

Target: $95.00 (9% target)

Stop: $82.00 (5% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

January 21

RS line NOT at 52W high (98.8% prox), RS vs SPY only +4.6% is weakest among candidates. Base_tight 6.3 is loose. No catalyst until January 2027 - 78 days out. Regional bank without near-term catalyst; monitor only. Conviction: Low.



LNTH

Lantheus Holdings, Inc.

$101.14

Pivot $101.27 | 0.1% away

RS vs SPY: +0.8%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.60B Cap | 59M Float

Drug Manufacturers - Specialty Radiopharmaceuticals | Theme: Radiopharmaceuticals & Diagnostic Imaging | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tig

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$101.27**
% to Pivot	**0.1%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.94 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**90.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**805k <**
Wk2	**937k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1241k**
Coil Strength	**35.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+0.8%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.60B**
Float	**59M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**24.5**
Fwd P/E	**15.6**
Rev Growth	**2.7%**
Short %	**6.5%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$106.99**

ENTRY TRIGGER

POST-EARNINGS: Close above $101.27 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (1.8M+ shares)

Target: $115.00 (14% target)

Stop: $94.00 (7% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 05

RS line NOT at 52W high (only 90.4%), RS vs SPY minimal (+0.8%) despite healthcare sector leadership. Earnings TOMORROW is binary risk. Revenue growth decelerating (2.7%) and earnings flat (-0.9%). Needs strong beat to change trajectory. Conviction: Low.

